

THE ECONOMICS OF ELECTIONS

Political parties are trying to outdo each other in the run-up to the General Elections as they try to attract voters

The recently concluded state elections saw parties including promises like farm loan waiver up to ₹2 lakh, subsidised LPG cylinders, and financial assistance to women in their election manifestos

The Karnataka state Budget in July had an outlay of about ₹60,000 crore annually to implement its five poll promises

Economists believe that genuine welfare measures can have an impact on development, but election freebies lead to higher public debt

Often, it is the voter who has to foot the bill through higher taxes



NOTE PICTURE FOR REPRESENTATION ONLY